

ASSOCIATION FOR DIGITAL PROGRESS

ADP - CODEX

ANTI-CORRUPTION AND ANTI-BRIBERY

POLICY

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1. Purpose

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX is committed to conducting all of its activities with honesty, integrity, transparency, and accountability.

Corruption undermines public trust, damages democratic institutions, weakens sustainable development, and diverts resources intended for the public good. As a civil society organization dedicated to digital transformation, education, innovation, and international cooperation, ADP adopts a zero-tolerance approach toward all forms of corruption, bribery, fraud, and unethical conduct.

The purpose of this Policy is to establish a comprehensive framework for preventing, detecting, reporting, and responding to corruption-related risks within all activities carried out by or on behalf of the Association.

This Policy aims to:

- promote an organizational culture based on integrity and ethical leadership;
- prevent bribery, corruption, fraud, extortion, and abuse of authority;
- protect the Association's reputation and credibility;
- ensure compliance with applicable national legislation and international anti-corruption standards;
- strengthen transparency and accountability in governance and financial management;
- provide guidance for ethical decision-making;
- safeguard donor resources and public funds;
- support fair competition, responsible procurement, and impartial decision-making.

Every individual acting on behalf of ADP shares responsibility for maintaining the highest standards of integrity and for protecting the Association from corruption risks.

2. Scope of the Policy

This Policy applies to every person acting for or representing the Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX, regardless of position or contractual status.

The Policy is binding upon:

- Members of the General Assembly;
- Members of the Board of Directors;
- Supervisory and advisory bodies;
- Employees;
- Volunteers;
- Interns;
- Consultants;
- Contractors;
- Temporary project personnel;
- Experts and evaluators;
- Procurement committee members;
- Partner organizations where required by agreement;
- Any third party acting on behalf of ADP.

Compliance with this Policy is a condition of participation in the governance, administration, employment, volunteering, procurement, and implementation of projects conducted by the Association.

Where contractual obligations or donor requirements establish higher anti-corruption standards, those higher standards shall prevail.

3. Definitions

For the purposes of this Policy, the following definitions apply.

Bribery

The offering, promising, giving, requesting, or accepting of any financial or non-financial advantage intended to improperly influence a decision or obtain an unfair benefit.

Corruption

The abuse of entrusted power for private gain.

Corruption includes bribery, fraud, extortion, embezzlement, favoritism, nepotism, abuse of authority, kickbacks, and other dishonest practices.

Fraud

Any intentional act of deception designed to obtain an unlawful financial or personal benefit.

Fraud may involve:

- false invoices;
- forged documents;
- false reporting;
- manipulation of procurement;
- misuse of project funds;
- falsification of financial statements;
- concealment of material information.

Conflict of Interest

A situation in which personal, family, political, or financial interests could improperly influence professional judgment or organizational decisions.

Facilitation Payment

An unofficial payment made to accelerate or secure routine governmental actions to which the payer is already legally entitled.

Public Official

Any person holding legislative, executive, administrative, judicial, or public service functions, whether elected, appointed, permanent, temporary, or unpaid.

Third Party

Any supplier, contractor, consultant, intermediary, project partner, service provider, or other external organization or individual acting on behalf of ADP.

Improper Advantage

Any benefit that is intended to influence an official action, procurement decision, contractual relationship, or organizational process in an unethical or unlawful manner.

4. Policy Statement

The Association for Digital Progress adopts a strict policy of zero tolerance toward corruption and bribery in all forms.

No employee, volunteer, Board member, consultant, contractor, partner, or representative of ADP may directly or indirectly engage in any corrupt practice.

The Association prohibits:

- offering bribes;
- accepting bribes;
- requesting bribes;
- facilitating bribery;
- paying kickbacks;
- misuse of donor funds;
- falsification of records;
- financial fraud;
- procurement manipulation;
- abuse of authority;
- nepotism;
- favoritism;
- undisclosed conflicts of interest.

Integrity shall always take precedence over financial gain, organizational convenience, or external pressure.

No project objective, funding opportunity, political relationship, or commercial interest shall justify unethical conduct.

The Board of Directors, senior management, employees, and volunteers are expected to demonstrate ethical leadership by promoting a culture of honesty, transparency, and accountability throughout the Association.

5. Core Principles

The implementation of this Policy is based upon the following principles.

5.1 Integrity

Every organizational decision shall be guided by honesty, fairness, and ethical responsibility.

5.2 Transparency

Financial management, procurement, governance, and project implementation shall be conducted openly and transparently.

5.3 Accountability

Every individual is accountable for their decisions and actions.

5.4 Independence

Organizational decisions shall remain free from improper political, financial, or personal influence.

5.5 Fairness

All procurement, recruitment, contracting, and partnership decisions shall be based on objective criteria.

5.6 Compliance

The Association complies with applicable national legislation, donor requirements, and internationally recognized anti-corruption standards.

5.7 Prevention

Preventing corruption is more effective than responding to corruption after it occurs.

Accordingly, ADP is committed to implementing preventive measures including:

- internal controls;
- transparent procurement;
- financial oversight;

- segregation of duties;
- ethics training;
- whistleblowing mechanisms;
- periodic audits;
- risk assessments.

6. Roles and Responsibilities

Preventing corruption is a shared responsibility throughout the Association. Every individual acting on behalf of ADP has a duty to uphold this Policy and contribute to a culture of integrity.

6.1 Board of Directors

The Board of Directors shall:

- demonstrate ethical leadership and set the "tone at the top";
- approve and periodically review this Policy;
- ensure adequate internal controls and governance mechanisms are in place;
- oversee corruption risk management;
- allocate sufficient resources for compliance and ethics activities;
- review reports concerning significant allegations of corruption;
- ensure that appropriate corrective actions are taken where necessary.

The Board shall promote a culture in which ethical conduct is recognized as an essential organizational value.

6.2 President and Executive Leadership

The President and senior leadership shall:

- lead by personal example;
- ensure implementation of this Policy throughout the Association;
- promote transparency in organizational decision-making;
- support ethical reporting mechanisms;
- ensure appropriate investigations of reported concerns;
- encourage continuous ethics education.

Leadership shall never request, encourage, ignore, or tolerate unethical conduct.

6.3 Employees and Volunteers

Every employee and volunteer shall:

- comply with this Policy;
- perform duties honestly and professionally;
- avoid conflicts of interest;
- report suspected misconduct;
- cooperate with internal investigations;
- protect organizational assets and resources.

Failure to report known corruption may itself constitute a breach of this Policy.

6.4 Project Managers

Project managers have additional responsibilities to:

- monitor project expenditures;
- ensure donor funds are used appropriately;
- supervise procurement processes;
- verify financial documentation;
- identify corruption risks at an early stage;
- ensure compliance with donor regulations.

7. Prohibited Conduct

ADP strictly prohibits any conduct that could compromise the integrity of the Association or undermine public confidence.

The following practices are expressly prohibited:

- offering or accepting bribes;
- soliciting improper advantages;
- paying or receiving kickbacks;
- embezzlement of organizational assets;
- misuse of donor funds;
- falsification of financial or administrative records;
- submission of false expense claims;
- manipulation of procurement procedures;
- collusion during tender processes;
- abuse of organizational authority;
- nepotism and favoritism;
- insider dealings;
- concealment of material information;
- destruction of financial records to avoid accountability;
- retaliation against individuals reporting misconduct.

Corruption may occur regardless of the monetary value involved. Even small improper payments may constitute serious ethical violations.

No person acting on behalf of ADP may attempt to circumvent this Policy through intermediaries, consultants, family members, suppliers, or other third parties.

8. Gifts, Hospitality and Entertainment

The Association recognizes that modest gifts and hospitality may occasionally arise during legitimate professional relationships. However, such benefits must never influence—or appear to influence—organizational decisions.

Individuals representing ADP shall neither offer nor accept gifts, hospitality, travel, entertainment, or other benefits that could:

- compromise impartiality;
- influence decision-making;
- create an expectation of preferential treatment;
- damage public confidence in the Association.

Acceptable gifts should:

- be of nominal value;
- comply with local laws and cultural customs;
- be infrequent;
- be openly disclosed where appropriate;
- never involve cash or cash equivalents.

The following are generally prohibited:

- cash payments;
- gift cards;
- personal loans;
- luxury travel;
- expensive accommodation;
- lavish entertainment;
- gifts during procurement or evaluation processes;
- gifts intended to influence official decisions.

Where there is uncertainty regarding the appropriateness of a gift or invitation, individuals should seek guidance from the President or the Board before accepting or offering it. The Association may establish an internal Gifts Register to document gifts exceeding a predefined threshold.

9. Conflicts of Interest

All organizational decisions shall be made solely in the best interests of ADP.

Individuals must avoid situations in which personal interests could interfere with their professional responsibilities.

Conflicts of interest may arise through:

- financial interests;
- family relationships;
- outside employment;
- ownership of supplier companies;
- consulting activities;
- political affiliations;
- personal friendships;
- close relationships with applicants or contractors.

Whenever an actual, potential, or perceived conflict exists, the individual shall:

- disclose the conflict promptly;
- withdraw from the relevant decision-making process;
- refrain from influencing others involved in the decision;
- comply with any mitigation measures adopted by the Association.

The existence of a conflict of interest does not necessarily imply misconduct; however, failure to disclose such conflicts may constitute a serious violation of this Policy.

10. Facilitation Payments

ADP strictly prohibits facilitation payments.

Facilitation payments are unofficial payments made to expedite routine administrative actions that public officials are already legally required to perform.

Examples include payments intended to:

- accelerate permits;
- speed up customs clearance;
- obtain routine approvals;
- avoid unnecessary administrative delays.

Such payments are prohibited regardless of local customs or business practices.

If an individual is placed under immediate threat to their health, safety, or personal liberty, any payment made under duress should be reported immediately to the Association and fully documented.

The Association shall maintain complete transparency regarding any such exceptional circumstances.

11. Political Contributions

ADP is an independent, non-partisan civil society organization.

Association funds, assets, facilities, equipment, or other organizational resources shall not be used to support political parties, political candidates, election campaigns, or partisan political activities unless expressly authorized by applicable law and approved through appropriate governance procedures.

Individuals remain free to participate in political activities in their personal capacity, provided that:

- they do not represent their personal opinions as official positions of ADP;
- organizational resources are not used;
- no conflict of interest arises;
- their political activities do not interfere with their organizational responsibilities.

The Association shall maintain institutional neutrality in all political matters while actively promoting democratic values, human rights, transparency, civic participation, and the rule of law.

12. Charitable Donations and Sponsorships

As a nonprofit organization, ADP may provide or receive donations, sponsorships, grants, or other forms of financial support consistent with its mission.

All donations and sponsorships shall:

- support legitimate public-interest objectives;
- comply with applicable legislation;
- be accurately documented;
- be transparently recorded;
- avoid conflicts of interest;
- never be used to disguise bribery or improper influence.

The Association shall conduct appropriate due diligence before entering into significant sponsorship or funding arrangements.

Donations shall never be offered or accepted in exchange for:

- procurement advantages;
- project awards;
- regulatory decisions;
- political influence;
- preferential treatment.

All significant sponsorship agreements should be approved according to the Association's internal governance procedures.

13. Procurement and Supplier Integrity

ADP is committed to ensuring that all procurement activities are conducted in a fair, transparent, competitive, and accountable manner.

Procurement decisions shall always be based on objective criteria, value for money, quality, reliability, sustainability, and the best interests of the Association.

All individuals involved in procurement shall:

- act impartially and independently;
- avoid favoritism or preferential treatment;
- comply with applicable procurement rules and donor requirements;
- disclose any actual or potential conflicts of interest;
- maintain confidentiality throughout procurement procedures;
- document procurement decisions appropriately.

The Association shall seek competition whenever practical and appropriate. Procurement processes should encourage equal opportunities for qualified suppliers.

Supplier selection should consider factors including:

- technical competence;
- financial stability;
- ethical business practices;
- legal compliance;
- environmental responsibility;

- previous performance;
- ability to deliver quality services.

Procurement decisions shall never be influenced by:

- gifts or hospitality;
- personal relationships;
- political influence;
- family connections;
- financial incentives;
- improper external pressure.

Suppliers and contractors are expected to comply with the ethical standards of ADP.

The Association reserves the right to terminate contractual relationships with suppliers involved in corruption, fraud, forced labour, child labour, human rights abuses, environmental misconduct, or other serious unethical practices.

Procurement documentation shall be retained in accordance with applicable legal and donor requirements.

14. Financial Controls and Record Keeping

Effective financial management is essential for preventing corruption and protecting the resources entrusted to the Association.

ADP shall maintain an effective system of internal financial controls designed to ensure that:

- financial transactions are properly authorized;
- expenditures are supported by appropriate documentation;
- accounting records are complete and accurate;
- organizational assets are safeguarded;
- donor funds are used exclusively for approved purposes;
- financial reporting is reliable and transparent.

Financial records shall:

- accurately reflect every transaction;
- never contain false or misleading information;
- be maintained in accordance with accepted accounting principles;
- be retained for legally required periods;
- be protected against unauthorized alteration or destruction.

The Association shall implement appropriate segregation of duties whenever possible.

Whenever practical, responsibility for:

- approving expenditures,
- processing payments,
- recording transactions,
- reconciling accounts,
- reviewing financial reports,

should be assigned to different individuals in order to reduce fraud risks.

Electronic financial systems should incorporate appropriate security measures, including access controls, audit trails, secure backups, and periodic review of user permissions.

Financial information shall be made available for internal and external audits whenever required.

15. Fraud Prevention

Fraud undermines organizational integrity, damages public confidence, and diverts resources away from the beneficiaries whom the Association serves.

ADP adopts a proactive approach to fraud prevention by promoting transparency, accountability, internal controls, and ethical leadership.

Fraud may include, but is not limited to:

- falsification of invoices;
- fabricated procurement documents;
- false travel or expense claims;
- duplicate payments;
- payroll fraud;
- manipulation of accounting records;
- misuse of project assets;
- unauthorized personal use of organizational property;
- forged signatures;
- identity fraud;
- cyber-enabled financial fraud.

To reduce fraud risks, the Association shall:

- conduct periodic risk assessments;
- maintain adequate financial controls;
- encourage whistleblowing;
- perform regular reconciliations;
- monitor high-risk transactions;
- conduct internal reviews where appropriate;
- cooperate fully with independent auditors.

All allegations of fraud shall be investigated promptly, objectively, and confidentially.

Confirmed cases of fraud shall result in appropriate disciplinary, contractual, civil, or criminal action depending upon the circumstances.

The Association is committed to recovering misappropriated assets whenever legally possible.

16. Third Parties and Business Partners

The ethical responsibilities of ADP extend beyond its own employees and volunteers.

The Association expects all third parties acting on its behalf to maintain standards consistent with this Policy.

Third parties include:

- consultants;
- contractors;
- suppliers;
- service providers;
- partner organizations;
- consortium members;
- project subcontractors;
- intermediaries;
- agents;
- external experts.

Before entering into significant contractual relationships, the Association should perform reasonable due diligence appropriate to the nature and level of risk.

Due diligence may include consideration of:

- legal status;
- ownership structure;
- financial reliability;

- professional reputation;
- previous project performance;
- compliance history;
- sanctions lists where applicable;
- corruption risk indicators.

Contracts with third parties should, whenever appropriate, include provisions requiring compliance with:

- applicable laws;
- anti-corruption obligations;
- ethical standards;
- financial reporting requirements;
- audit rights;
- termination clauses for serious misconduct.

The Association shall not knowingly engage with organizations or individuals that have been convicted of serious corruption offences or that present unacceptable ethical risks.

Where misconduct by a third party is identified, ADP shall take appropriate corrective action, which may include suspension, termination of contracts, recovery of funds, or referral to competent authorities.

17. Reporting Concerns (Whistleblowing)

The Association encourages a culture in which concerns regarding corruption, fraud, bribery, or other unethical conduct can be raised without fear of retaliation.

Every individual associated with ADP has both the right and the responsibility to report suspected misconduct.

Reports may relate to:

- bribery;
- corruption;
- fraud;
- financial irregularities;
- procurement misconduct;
- conflicts of interest;
- abuse of authority;
- falsification of records;
- misuse of organizational assets;
- violations of this Policy.

Reports should be made as soon as reasonably possible through confidential reporting channels established by the Association.

Anonymous reports may also be considered where sufficient information is provided to enable an effective review.

Individuals are encouraged to report concerns in good faith based on reasonable belief.

The Association shall:

- acknowledge receipt of reports where possible;
- protect confidentiality to the maximum extent practicable;
- review concerns promptly;
- conduct fair and impartial assessments;
- protect reporting persons from retaliation.

Knowingly submitting false or malicious reports constitutes misconduct and may result in disciplinary action.

The Association recognizes that whistleblowers play an essential role in strengthening integrity, preventing corruption, and protecting the public interest.

18. Investigation Procedures

The Association is committed to ensuring that all allegations of corruption, bribery, fraud, or other serious misconduct are investigated promptly, fairly, objectively, and confidentially.

Every investigation shall respect the principles of:

- impartiality;
- independence;
- confidentiality;
- due process;
- proportionality;
- respect for the rights and dignity of all persons involved.

Upon receiving a report, the Association shall:

1. acknowledge receipt of the allegation where appropriate;
2. conduct an initial assessment to determine credibility and potential risk;
3. decide whether a formal investigation is required;
4. appoint impartial individuals to conduct the investigation;
5. collect and preserve relevant documentation and evidence;
6. provide the individual concerned with an opportunity to respond;
7. prepare a written report summarizing findings and recommendations;
8. determine appropriate corrective actions.

Investigations shall be conducted as efficiently as possible while ensuring fairness and thoroughness. Confidential information obtained during investigations shall only be shared with individuals who have a legitimate need to know.

Where required by law, or where criminal conduct is reasonably suspected, the Association shall cooperate fully with competent public authorities.

The Association may engage independent legal, financial, or forensic experts whenever the complexity or seriousness of a case requires external expertise.

19. Protection Against Retaliation

ADP recognizes that individuals may hesitate to report misconduct if they fear retaliation.

The Association strictly prohibits retaliation against any person who, in good faith:

- reports suspected misconduct;
- provides information during an investigation;
- assists auditors or investigators;
- refuses to participate in corrupt activities;
- raises legitimate ethical concerns.

Retaliation may include:

- dismissal;
- demotion;
- harassment;
- intimidation;
- threats;
- discrimination;
- exclusion from projects;
- reduction of responsibilities;
- reputational harm;

- any other adverse treatment resulting from protected reporting.

Any act of retaliation constitutes a serious violation of this Policy.

Individuals who believe they have experienced retaliation should report the matter immediately.

The Association shall investigate allegations of retaliation with the same seriousness applied to allegations of corruption.

Protection under this Policy does not extend to individuals who knowingly make false or malicious allegations.

20. Training and Awareness

Prevention is most effective when individuals understand both the risks of corruption and their responsibilities under this Policy.

The Association is committed to promoting a culture of integrity through continuous education and awareness.

ADP shall, where appropriate:

- provide orientation on this Policy to new employees and volunteers;
- organize periodic ethics and anti-corruption training;
- promote awareness of corruption risks in project implementation;
- provide practical guidance for procurement and financial management;
- encourage discussion of ethical dilemmas;
- distribute updated guidance when legal or donor requirements change.

Training activities should be proportionate to organizational size, operational risks, and available resources.

Individuals occupying positions involving procurement, financial management, project administration, or senior leadership may receive additional specialized training.

The Association encourages continuous learning as an essential component of good governance.

21. Monitoring, Compliance and Audit

The effectiveness of this Policy depends upon continuous monitoring and periodic evaluation.

The Board of Directors shall oversee implementation of this Policy and ensure that appropriate compliance mechanisms remain in place.

The Association shall periodically review:

- corruption risk assessments;
- procurement procedures;
- financial controls;
- internal reporting mechanisms;
- audit findings;
- implementation of corrective actions;
- compliance with donor requirements.

Internal monitoring may include:

- management reviews;
- financial reconciliations;
- procurement reviews;
- project monitoring;
- internal compliance assessments.

Independent external audits shall be welcomed as an important mechanism for strengthening transparency and public confidence.

Recommendations arising from audits or compliance reviews should be evaluated promptly and implemented whenever appropriate.

The Association is committed to continuous improvement rather than merely achieving minimum compliance.

22. Violations and Disciplinary Measures

Violations of this Policy shall be addressed promptly, fairly, and consistently.

The nature of any disciplinary action shall depend upon:

- the seriousness of the violation;
- intent;
- financial impact;
- organizational risk;
- previous conduct;
- cooperation during the investigation.

Possible measures include:

- verbal warning;
- written warning;
- mandatory ethics or compliance training;
- increased supervision;
- temporary suspension of duties;
- removal from procurement or financial responsibilities;
- termination of contracts or volunteer assignments;
- dismissal from employment where applicable;
- removal from elected or appointed positions in accordance with the Statute;
- recovery of improperly obtained funds;
- referral to competent authorities.

Disciplinary decisions shall always respect applicable legislation, contractual rights, and principles of procedural fairness.

The Association reserves the right to seek restitution for financial losses resulting from fraudulent or corrupt conduct.

23. Review of the Policy

ADP recognizes that corruption risks evolve alongside organizational growth, technological developments, and changes in legislation.

Accordingly, this Policy shall be reviewed periodically to ensure its continued effectiveness and relevance.

As a general principle, the Policy should be reviewed at least once every three years or earlier whenever:

- significant legal reforms occur;
- donor requirements change;
- new corruption risks emerge;
- organizational restructuring takes place;
- audit findings indicate the need for revision.

Suggestions for amendments may be submitted by:

- the Board of Directors;
- employees;
- volunteers;
- committees;
- external auditors;
- legal advisors;

- partner organizations where appropriate.

All revisions shall be approved according to the governance procedures established by the Association.

The most recent version shall be communicated to all relevant stakeholders.

24. Final Provisions

This Anti-Corruption and Anti-Bribery Policy was adopted by the Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX as an essential component of its governance framework and ethical commitment.

The Policy shall enter into force on the date of its approval by the competent governing body of the Association.

Compliance with this Policy is mandatory for all persons acting on behalf of ADP.

Nothing in this Policy limits the application of national legislation, international legal obligations, donor regulations, or contractual requirements.

Where applicable laws or donor requirements establish higher standards than those contained in this Policy, the higher standard shall prevail.

The Board of Directors is responsible for promoting awareness of this Policy, overseeing its implementation, and ensuring that appropriate governance mechanisms remain effective.

By adopting this Policy, ADP reaffirms its unwavering commitment to:

- integrity;
- transparency;
- accountability;
- ethical leadership;
- responsible stewardship of resources;
- prevention of corruption;
- protection of the public interest.

The Association believes that preventing corruption is not solely a legal obligation but a shared ethical responsibility that strengthens public trust, protects donor resources, promotes sustainable development, and supports the long-term success of the organization.

Appendix A – Declaration of Compliance

Declaration of Compliance with the Anti-Corruption and Anti-Bribery Policy

I acknowledge that I have received, read, and understood the Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX Anti-Corruption and Anti-Bribery Policy.

I understand that compliance with this Policy is a condition of my participation in the activities of the Association. I agree to conduct my responsibilities with honesty, integrity, transparency, and accountability, and to comply with all applicable anti-corruption requirements.

I also understand my obligation to report, in good faith, any suspected violation of this Policy.

Name	Position	Signature	Date
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